

Chips Up, Tape Down

S&P -0.29% , Dow -1.09% as Trump calls the Iran deal ‘over’ and crude extends its Hormuz bid — but Nvidia $\uparrow 3.65\%$ leads chips off Tuesday’s rout. Growth ($\uparrow 0.17\%$) and Dividend (-0.02%) both beat.

THE SESSION

The de-rating didn’t extend. Tuesday closed with the chip complex in a two-front reprice — a Samsung earnings miss and reports of a DeepSeek in-house inference chip cracking the semis lower. Wednesday answered the open question directly: the sleeve snapped back rather than following through. Nvidia led it, closing $\uparrow 3.65\%$ at \$204.12 as one of the few names the tape wanted to own, and the rest of the complex followed — CRDO $\uparrow 4.99\%$, NXPI $\uparrow 3.93\%$, KEYS $\uparrow 2.63\%$, LRCX $\uparrow 2.15\%$, QCOM $\uparrow 1.96\%$, TSM $\uparrow 1.02\%$. The one-day de-rating stayed a one-day de-rating.

But the index tape didn’t come with it. The S&P 500 closed -0.29% at 7,481.75 and the Dow gave back 1.09% to 52,348, with the Russell 2000 off 0.88% — breadth stayed heavy even as the Nasdaq eked out $\uparrow 0.19\%$ on Nvidia’s bid. The overhang was geopolitical: on the record from Ankara, the President called the late-June Iran framework ‘over,’ and the S&P dipped intraday on the headline. Crude extended its Strait-of-Hormuz premium, and the energy names carried the offset — Valero $\uparrow 6.26\%$, Devon $\uparrow 2.12\%$, Chevron $\uparrow 1.10\%$, ONEOK $\uparrow 0.54\%$.

The other current ran through rates. Into the first Warsh-chaired FOMC minutes — the committee’s only on-record read on a September hike after the Chair sat out the June dot plot — the rate-sensitive corners bore the weight. Synchrony fell 9.61% and Toll Brothers 4.02%, consumer-credit and housing proxies both, while the utilities softened (NEE -1.16% , EIX -1.27%). The VIX firmed 2.85% to 16.59 — a lean, not a spasm. Gold eased 1.60% and Bitcoin slipped to \$62,177 (-1.80%), dragging the digital-asset ETFs with it (IBIT -2.54% , ETHA -2.96%).

IOWN Tactical: With the S&P still within roughly a percent of Monday’s record and far above the spring lows, the framework

keeps us in the trim-and-build-cash zone, not the buy zone. A -0.29% session on a hawkish-lean, geopolitically noisy tape is exactly the kind of wobble that does not trip the -20% first tranche — we let it pass.

IOWN HOLDINGS: NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

HUT $+9.69\%$ GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Extended the AI-infrastructure bid, decoupling cleanly from a lower Bitcoin as the crypto-miner-to-HPC conversion thesis kept drawing capital. Closed at \$106.11 after trading as low as \$94.49.

VLO $+6.26\%$ DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Best day in the book. The refiner caught the full force of the Hormuz crude bid as the President declared the Iran framework over; closed at \$282.88, up \$16.66.

CRDO $+4.99\%$ GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Front-ran the chip snap-back, closing at \$258.69 off a \$240.50 low — a near-full reversal of Tuesday’s connectivity-name reset.

NXPI $+3.93\%$ GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Rode the semis recovery to \$283.89, recovering essentially all of the prior session’s de-rating.

NVDA $+3.65\%$ GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Led the tape. One of the session’s few clear bright spots, closing at \$204.12 and pulling the broader chip complex up with it.

DVN $+2.12\%$ DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Upstream energy captured the geopolitical premium alongside the refiners; closed at \$43.31.

QCOM $+1.96\%$ DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Participated in the chip recovery, closing at \$186.56 after a \$180.50 intraday low.

DECLINERS

SYF -9.61% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

The session’s sharpest hit. The consumer-finance name took the brunt of the rate-sensitive repricing into the Warsh minutes; closed at \$68.26 with earnings still ahead on July 21.

TOL -4.02% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Homebuilders leaned with the rate read; Toll closed at \$145.55, near its intraday low.

AEM -3.62% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Gold miners tracked bullion’s 1.60% pullback; Agnico closed at \$144.89.

GPC -3.06% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Gave back with the cyclical-value cohort; closed at \$124.73.

CHD -2.81% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Staples names unwound Tuesday’s defensive bid as money rotated back toward chips; closed at \$96.17.

COIN −2.54%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Tracked Bitcoin lower on the risk-off crypto tone tied to the Iran headline; closed at \$159.36.

HOLDINGS NEWS

Marvell (Growth Portfolio) stabilized after a bruising stretch. MRVL closed ↑0.44% at \$231.71, a modest steadying after a roughly 22.6% slide tied to its index removal and reports of Nvidia’s \$2 billion in-house AI investment. The stabilization fits Wednesday’s broader chip snap-back — the tape stopped pressing the connectivity names lower even where the fundamental overhang remains.

PORTFOLIO PERFORMANCE

DIVIDEND STRATEGY

✓ BEAT BOTH

−0.02%

vs. DVY −1.03% | SPY −0.33%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO

✓ BEAT BOTH

+0.17%

vs. IUSG +0.10% | SPY −0.33%

YEAR-TO-DATE

Dividend +16.23% vs DVY +13.82% / SPY +9.87%

Growth +17.37% vs IUSG +11.28%

Both books outperformed on a mixed tape. The Dividend Strategy held essentially flat at −0.02%, well ahead of DVY (−1.03%) and SPY (−0.33%) as its energy and healthcare names offset the rate-sensitive drag. The Growth Portfolio gained 0.17%, topping IUSG (↑0.10%) and SPY, carried by the chip recovery and HUT’s surge against the SYF and TOL declines. Year-to-date, Dividend leads at ↑16.23% (vs DVY ↑13.82%, SPY ↑9.87%) and Growth at ↑17.37% (vs IUSG ↑11.28%).